introduced into India several thousand years before. It is cultivated in India, Myanmar, south asian countries and several African and Central American countries. Tamarind has long been used in Africa and in Southern Asia. The name tamarindus is of Arabian origin, which means "dates of India". (tamar – dates; Indus – India).

Uses

It is used in flavouring sauces in the United States and Mexico. In India, the fruit pulp is major ingredients for many culinary preparations. Sweet tamarinds are sold as table fruits in India imported from Thailand and Malaysia.

10.3 Fibres

Botanically a fiber is a long narrow and thick-walled cell.

Cotton

Botanical name : *Gossypium* spp.

Family : Malvaceae

Cotton is the world's most important non-food commercial crop.

Origin and Area of cultivation: It is one of the oldest cultivated crops of the world. It has been cultivated for about 8000 years both in new world and in old world. Commercial cotton comes from four cotton species: two from the new world and two from the old world. (1) *G. hirsutum* (2) *G.barbadense* are the New world species and (3) *G. arboretum* (4) *G. herbaceum* are the old world species. In India cotton is cultivated in Gujarat, Maharashtra, Andhra Pradesh and Tamil Nadu.

Uses

It is mainly used in the manufacturing of various textile, hosiery products, toys and is also used in hospitals.

Jute

Botanical name : *Corchorus* spp.

Family : Malvaceae

Origin and Area of cultivation: Jute is derived from the two cultivated species (1) *Corchorus capsularis* and (2) *C.olitorius* is of African origin whereas *C. capsularis,* is believed to be Indo-Burmese origin. It is an important cultivated commercial crop in Gangetic plains of India and Bangladesh.

Uses

It is one of the largest exported fibre material of India. The jute industry occupies an important place in the national economy of India. Jute is used for 'safe' packaging in view of being natural, renewable, bio-degradable and eco-friendly product. It is used in bagging and wrapping textile. About 75% of the jute produced is used for manufacturing sacks and bags. It is also used in manufacture of blankets, rags, curtains etc. It is also being used as a textile fibre in recent years.


Cotton plant


Jute products

Figure 10.12: Fibres

10.4 Timber

The basic need of shelter is obtained from the timber trees.

Teak

Botanical name : *Tectona grandis*

Family: Lamiaceae

Origin and Area of cultivation: This is native to South east Asia. It is observed wild in Assam. But cultivated in Bengal, Assam, Kerala, Tamil Nadu and North-West India.


Teak wood carving

Figure 10.13: Timber

Uses

It is one of best timbers of the world.

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